Day 32 (stop 1 of 2) - Songbird, Meltwater

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Caledon Hills section · hike 41 · Song Bird Nature Reserve & Meltwater Moraine

4.5 km / 2.8 mi	~1.3 h	2.3 km new	48 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

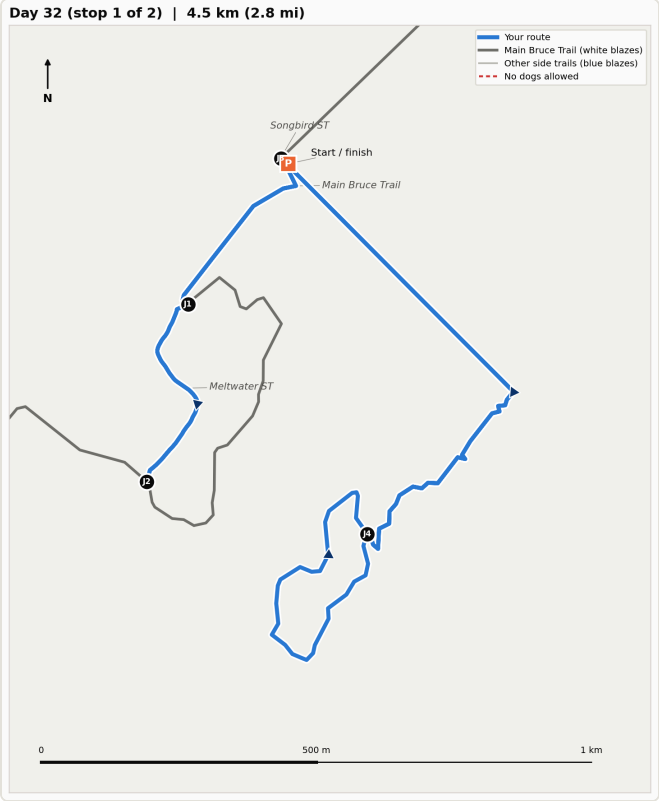
Park (P): Roadside parking on the west side of Airport Road, across from Finnerty Sideroad. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day32a_hike041.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Songbird Side Trail (1.9 km); Meltwater Side Trail (0.4 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 2 on day 32 (7.5 mi of hiking, about 114 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 42, 4.7 mi from A parking lot located off the 7th Line immediately east of Airport Rd. This lot was....

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** roadside on the west side of Airport Road, across from Finnerty Sideroad. Airport Road is busy, so load the dog on the side away from traffic.
- **Road walking:** since the main Trail moved off Airport Road in 2025, the Songbird Side Trail is no longer connected to it, and you walk a stretch of road shoulder to reach it. Several shorter main-Trail stretches also follow road shoulders. Keep the dog close.
- **Songbird Side Trail:** passes through mature sugar maple forest, hedgerows and thickets, and old farm meadow now in native grasses. It's an eBird hotspot; listen for Indigo Bunting, Brown Thrasher, Bobolink and Eastern Meadowlark. Volunteers hauled out two bins of scrap metal in 2012, the year the trail was blazed.
- **Meltwater Side Trail:** A 420 m side trail opened in July 2025 in the Meltwater Moraine protected natural area, which the BTC secured that year. With the main Trail it makes a 1.3 km loop through the northeastern part of the property; this route uses it twice.
- **Dogs:** allowed on leash, but not on the Paris Moraine Side Trail, which branches off this part of the main Trail: the BTC made it a no-dog zone (between Escarpment Sideroad and the main Trail), so this plan leaves it out. Keep Zappy on the trail in the meadows, where ground-nesting birds like Bobolink live.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

> **Can't do it all in one go?** Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 1.5 km / 0.9 mi, covering Meltwater. **Outing 2** from the planned parking (P) again: 3.0 km / 1.9 mi, covering Songbird. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking on the west side of Airport Road, across from Finnerty Sideroad. Head south on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail.
0.4	0.2	J1: Continue straight onto the blue-blazed Meltwater Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
0.8	0.5	J2: Turnaround point. The side trail meets the white-blazed main Bruce Trail here. Turn around and retrace your steps.

1.2	0.7	J1: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
1.5	1.0	J3: You pass the start again. Keep going on the blue-blazed Songbird Side Trail, heading south-east.
2.6	1.6	J4: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Songbird Side Trail, heading north-west. (the blue-blazed Songbird Side Trail goes off on your left.) This is a short excursion (about 810 m in all): walk the whole Songbird Side Trail, including the short loop or branch near its end (see the map), and come back to this junction.
3.4	2.1	J4: Junction. Turn sharp right to stay on the Songbird Side Trail, heading south-east. (the Songbird Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
3.9	2.4	Heads-up: The next 0.6 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
4.5	2.8	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Caledon Hills Bruce Trail Club's Songbird and Paris Moraine side-trail stories.